

Lecture One

1 Real Functions

1.1 Introduction

The relation between two sets X and Y is a set of ordered pairs each of the form (x, y) where $x \in X$ and $y \in Y$. A **function** from X to Y is a relation between X and Y that has the property that any two ordered pairs with the same x -value also have the same y -value. Then we called x **the independent variable** and y **the dependent variable**.

Definition 1.1.1 Real-Valued function of a Real Variable:

Let X and Y be sets of real numbers. A **real-valued function** f of a real variable x from X to Y is a correspondence that assigns to each number x in X exactly one number in Y .

$X \equiv$ The domain of f

$Y \equiv$ The Co-domain

Note: The number y is the image of x under f and is denoted by $f(x)$ which is called the value of f at x . The **range** of f is a subset of Y and consists of all images of numbers in X .

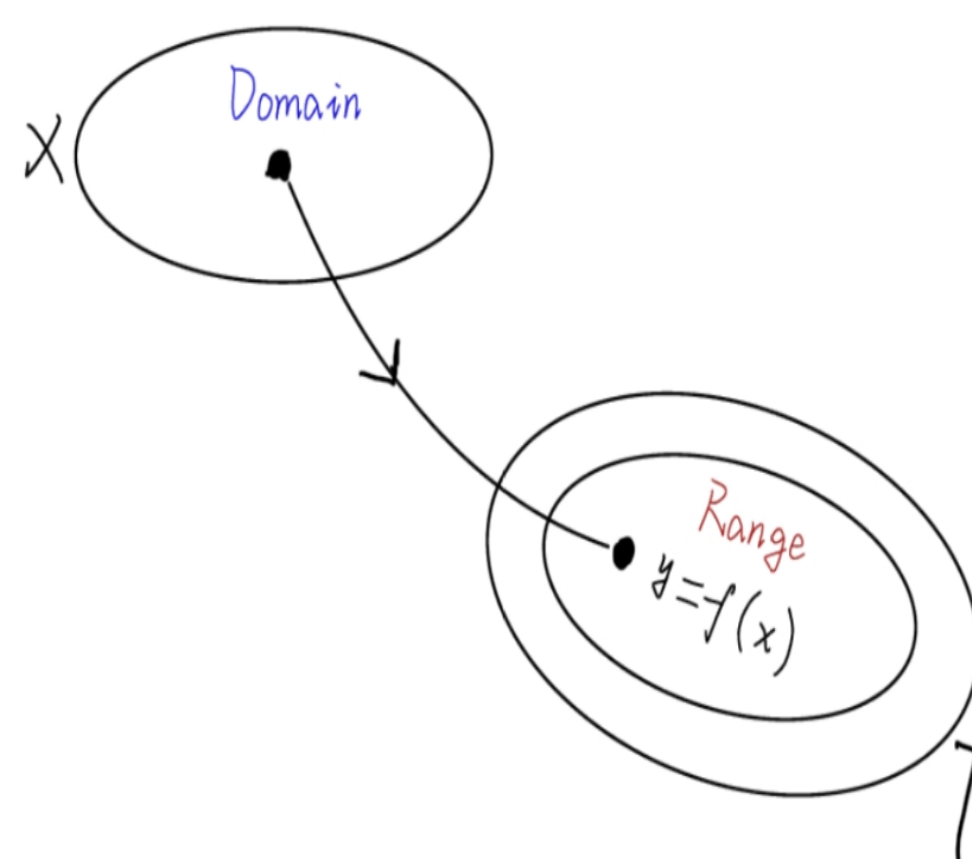


Figure 1: A real-valued function f of a real variable

For example: The area A of a circle is a function of the circle's radius r , and written as:

$$A = \pi r^2$$

Where

$A \equiv$ dependent variable

$r \equiv$ independent variable

Example 1.1.1 Given $f(x) = x^2 + 3$, evaluate the following:

1. $f(2)$
2. $f(-1)$
3. $f(3a)$
4. $f(1 - a)$
5. $\frac{f(x + \Delta x) - f(x)}{\Delta x}, \Delta x \neq 0$

Sol

1. $f(2) = (2)^2 + 3 = 4 + 3 = 7$
2. $f(-1) = (-1)^2 + 3 = 1 + 3 = 4$
3. $f(3a) = (3a)^2 + 3 = 9a^2 + 3$
4. $f(1 - a) = (1 - a)^2 + 3 = a^2 - 2a + 4$
5. $\frac{f(x + \Delta x) - f(x)}{\Delta x} = \frac{(x + \Delta x)^2 + 3 - (x^2 + 3)}{\Delta x} = 2x + \Delta x$

1.2 Types of Functions

1. **Polynomial Functions:** is a function of the form $y = f(x) = a_0x^n + a_1x^{n-1} + a_2x^{n-2} + \dots + a_n$ where $a_0, a_1, \dots, a_n$ are constants. For example $y = ax^3 + bx^2 + cx + d$ is a polynomial function from the third degree.
2. **Algebraic Functions:** is a function of the form $P_0(x)y^n + P_1(x)y^{n-1} + \dots + P_n(x) = 0$ where $P_0(x), P_1(x), \dots, P_n(x)$ are polynomials and all powers of x, y are in $\mathbf{Z}^+$.
For example $x^2y^3 + xy^2 - 2y + x + 7 = 0$

3. **Rational Functions:** is of the form:

$$f(x) = \frac{P(x)}{R(x)}$$

is called rational function, where $P(x), R(x)$ are polynomials. For example

$$f(x) = \frac{2x^2 + 3x + 1}{1 - 4x}$$

4. **Trigonometric Functions:**

- (i) $y = \sin x$
- (ii) $y = \cos x$
- (iii) $y = \tan x = \frac{\sin x}{\cos x}$
- (iv) $y = \cot x = \frac{\cos x}{\sin x}$
- (v) $y = \sec x = \frac{1}{\cos x}$
- (vi) $y = \csc x = \frac{1}{\sin x}$

5. **Inverse Trigonometric Functions:**

- (a) $\sin y = x \iff y = \sin^{-1} x$
- (b) $\cos y = x \iff y = \cos^{-1} x$
- (c) $\tan y = x \iff y = \tan^{-1} x$
- (d) $\cot y = x \iff y = \cot^{-1} x$
- (e) $\sec y = x \iff y = \sec^{-1} x$
- (f) $\csc y = x \iff y = \csc^{-1} x$

6. **Exponential Functions:**

- (i) $y = f(x) = a^x$ ($a \equiv \text{constant}$)
- (ii) $y = f(x) = e^x$ ($e = 2.71828$)

where $a \equiv \text{the base}$ and $x \equiv \text{exponent}$

7. **Logarithmic Functions:**

- (i) $y = \log_a x$, $a > 1$
- (ii) $y = \log_{10} x = \log x$
- (iii) $y = \log_e x = \ln x$

Every exponential form can be transformed to logarithmic form as:

$$y = \log_a x \iff x = a^y$$

$$y = \ln x \iff x = e^y$$

8. **Hyperbolic Functions:**

- (a) $y = \sinh x$
- (b) $y = \cosh x$

$$(c) \ y = \tanh x = \frac{\sinh x}{\cosh x}$$

$$(d) \ y = \coth x = \frac{\cosh x}{\sinh x}$$

$$(e) \ y = \operatorname{sech} x = \frac{1}{\cosh x}$$

$$(f) \ y = \operatorname{csch} x = \frac{1}{\sinh x}$$

9. Inverse Hyperbolic Functions:

$$(a) \ \sinh y = x \iff y = \sinh^{-1} x$$

$$(b) \ \cosh y = x \iff y = \cosh^{-1} x$$

$$(c) \ \tanh y = x \iff y = \tanh^{-1} x$$

$$(d) \ \coth y = x \iff y = \coth^{-1} x$$

$$(e) \ \operatorname{sech} y = x \iff y = \operatorname{sech}^{-1} x$$

$$(f) \ \operatorname{csch} y = x \iff y = \operatorname{csch}^{-1} x$$

1.3 The Domain and Range of a Function:

The domain of definition for the functions:

1. Polynomial functions

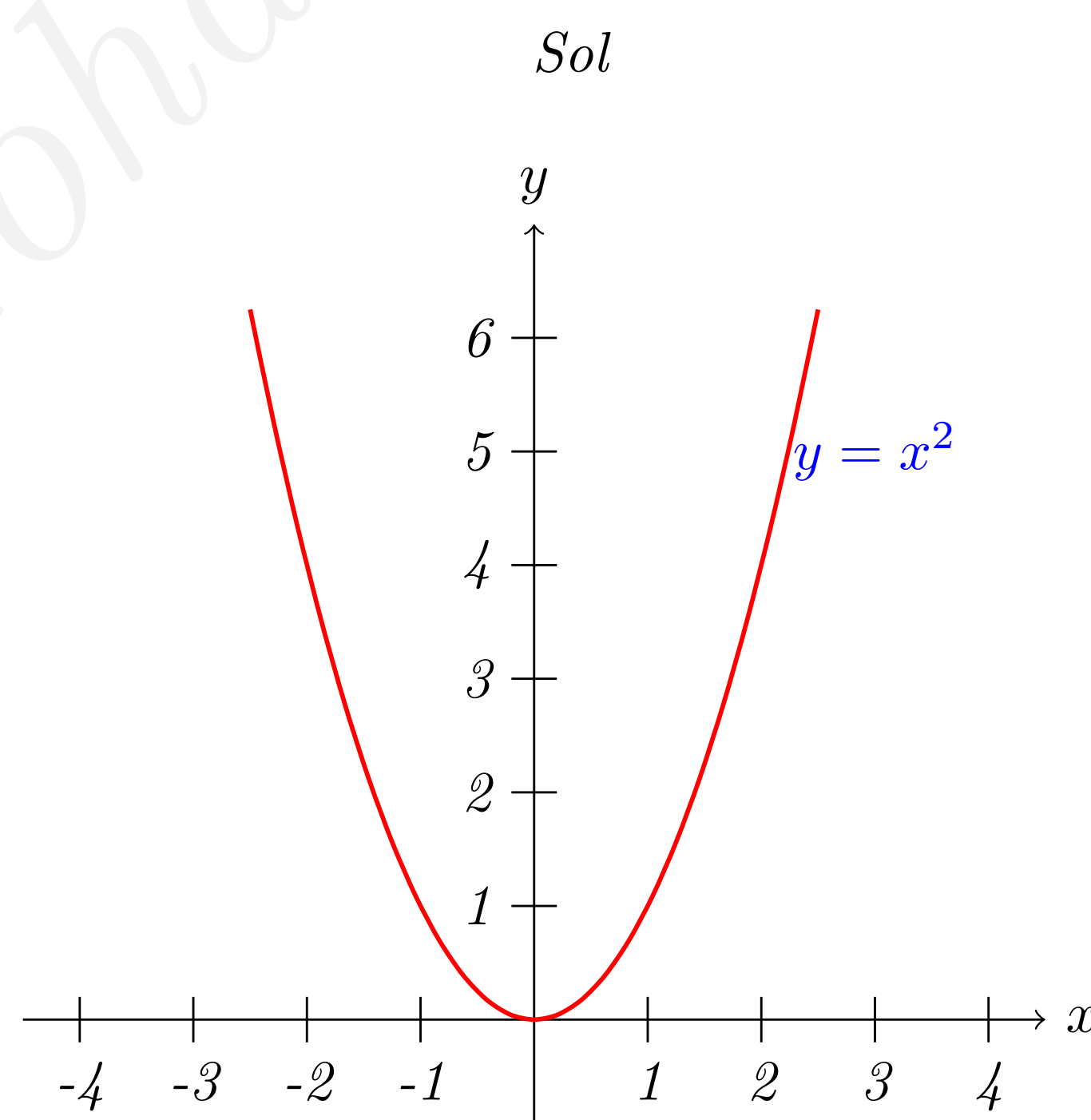
2. $y = \sin x$ and $y = \cos x$

3. The rational function $f(x) = \frac{P(x)}{R(x)}$ where $R(x)$ cannot be factorised on $\mathbb{R}$ and $P(x)$ is polynomial

is **the set of real numbers** $\mathbb{R}$ and we write it as

$$D = \mathbb{R} \text{ or } D = (-\infty, \infty) \text{ or } D =]-\infty, \infty[$$

Example 1.3.2 Find the domain and the range of the function $y = x^2$

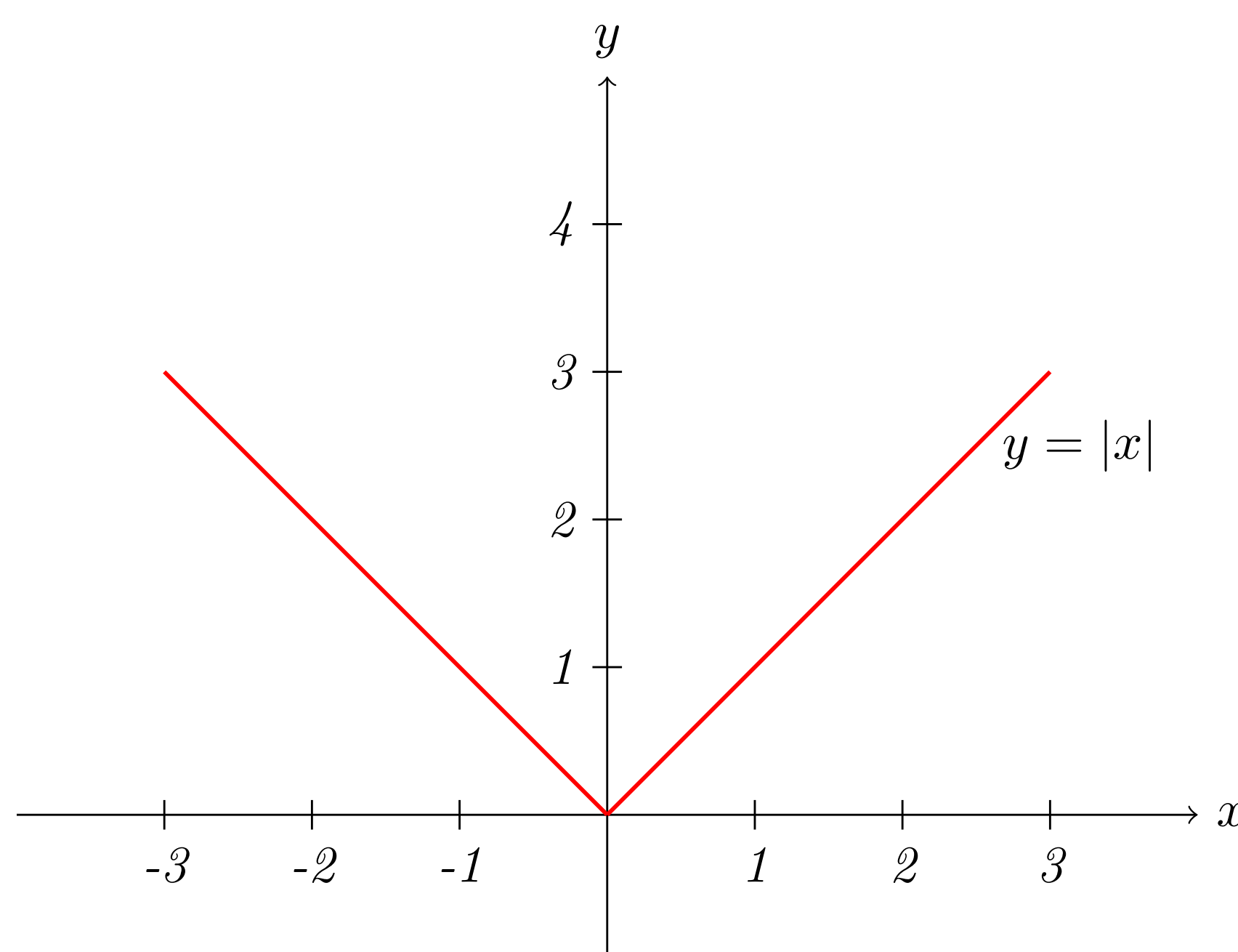


Clearly $y = x^2$ is a polynomial function and $\forall x = a \in \mathbb{R}, f(a) \in \mathbb{R}$. i.e. $D = \mathbb{R} = (-\infty, \infty)$. The range of $y = x^2$ is all of the positive numbers such that $0 \leq x < \infty \equiv [0, \infty)$.

$$\therefore D = \mathbb{R} \text{ and } \mathcal{R} = [0, \infty)$$

Example 1.3.3 Find the domain and the range of the function $y = |x|$

Sol

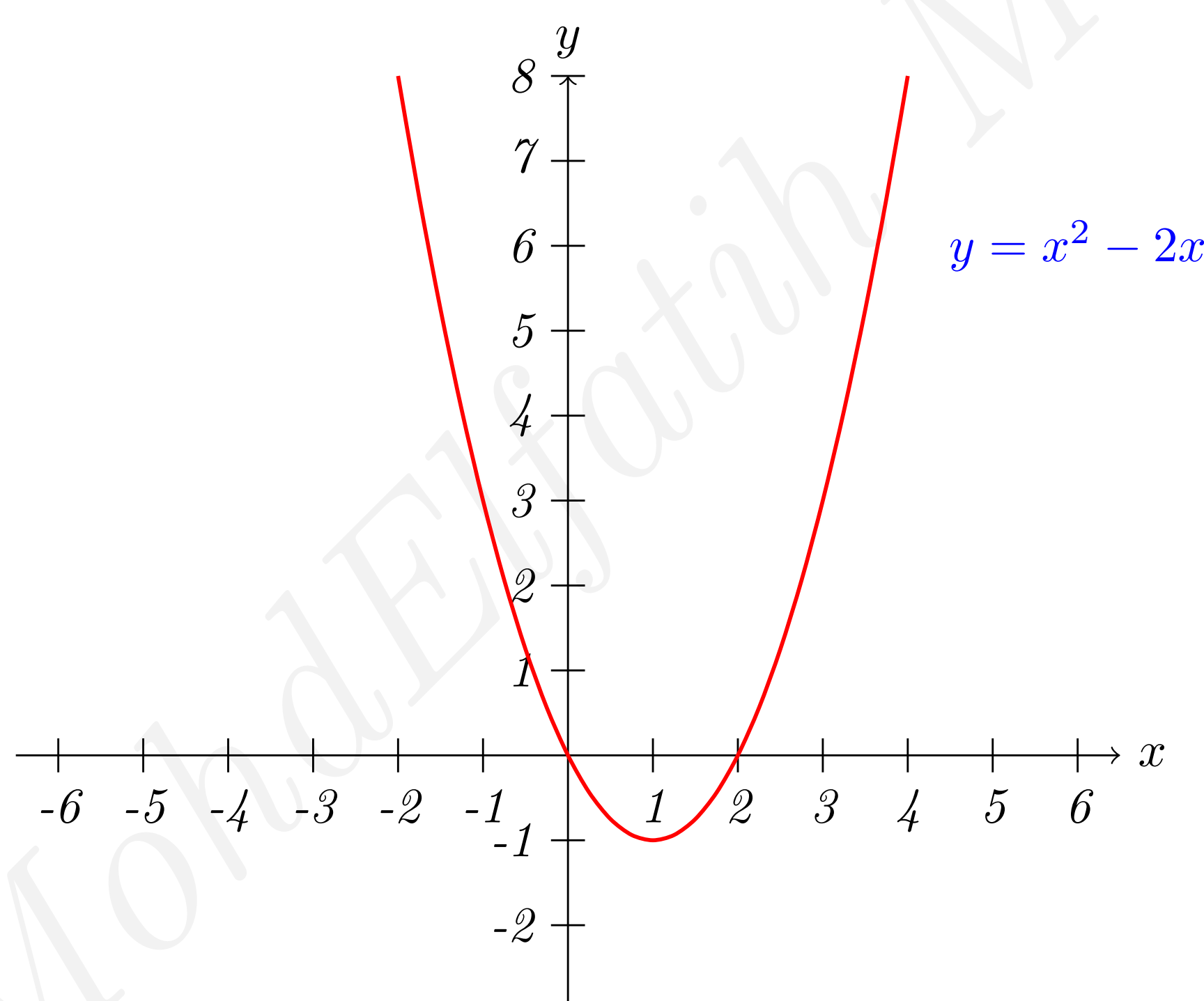


$$\forall x \in \mathbb{R}, \exists y \in \mathbb{R} \text{ s.t. } y \in [0, \infty)$$

Therefore $D = \mathbb{R}$ and $\mathcal{R} = [0, \infty)$

Example 1.3.4 Find the domain and the range of the function $y = x^2 - 2x$

Sol



Clearly, the given function is polynomial, therefore the domain is $\mathbb{R}$.

$$D = (-\infty, \infty)$$

To find the range:

$$y = x^2 - 2x + 1 - 1 = (x - 1)^2 - 1$$

The minimum value of $y = -1$ when $(x - 1)^2 = \text{zero}$ at $(x = 1)$, thus $y \geq -1$.
 $\Rightarrow D = \mathbb{R}$, $\mathcal{R} = [-1, \infty)$

Example 1.3.5 Find the domain and the range of the function $y = \frac{2}{x - 3}$

Sol

The given function is rational $\Rightarrow x - 3 = 0 \Rightarrow x = 3$

Thus $D = \mathbb{R} - \{3\}$ « $[\mathbb{R} - \{\text{zeros of denominator}\}]$ »

Now: To find the range :

$$y = \frac{2}{x-3} \Rightarrow x-3 = \frac{2}{y} \Rightarrow \boxed{x = \frac{2}{y} + 3} \Rightarrow y \in \mathbb{R} - \{0\} \quad \neq$$

Example 1.3.6 Find the domain and the range of the function $\sqrt{2x^2 + x}$

Sol

$$y = \sqrt{x(2x+1)} \quad ; y \in \mathbb{R} \text{ only in case of } x(2x+1) \geq 0$$

① x and $(2x+1)$ are +ve:

$$\begin{aligned} \Rightarrow x > 0 \quad \wedge \quad 2x+1 > 0 \\ \Rightarrow x > 0 \quad \wedge \quad x > -\frac{1}{2} \\ \Rightarrow \left[-\frac{1}{2}, \infty\right) \cap [0, \infty) = [0, \infty) \end{aligned}$$

② $x \leq 0 \quad \wedge \quad (2x+1) \leq 0$ [both -ve]

$$\begin{aligned} \Rightarrow x \leq 0 \quad \wedge \quad x \leq -\frac{1}{2} \\ \Rightarrow (-\infty, 0] \cap (-\infty, -\frac{1}{2}] = (-\infty, -\frac{1}{2}] \end{aligned}$$

therefore, we conclude that

$$x \in (-\infty, -\frac{1}{2}] \cup [0, \infty)$$

* Range « exercise »

1.4 Combinations of Functions

Two functions can be combined in various ways to create new functions.

Example 1.4.7 Let $f(x) = 2x - 3$ and $g(x) = x^2 + 1$, we can form the functions

1. Sum

$$(f+g)(x) = f(x) + g(x) = (2x-3) + (x^2+1) = x^2 + 2x - 2$$

2. Difference

$$(f-g)(x) = f(x) - g(x) = (2x-3) - (x^2+1) = 2x - x^2 - 4$$

3. Product

$$(fg)(x) = f(x)g(x) = (2x-3)(x^2+1)$$

4. quotient

$$\left(\frac{f}{g}\right)(x) = \frac{f(x)}{g(x)} = \frac{2x-3}{x^2+1}$$

Also we can combine two functions in yet another way, called **composition**.

Definition 1.4.2 Composition of Functions

Let f and g be functions of x , the function given by $(f \circ g)(x) = f(g(x))$ is called the composite of f with g .

Note:

1. Domain of $(f \circ g)$ is the set of all x in the domain of g such that $g(x)$ is in the domain of f .
2. $(f \circ g)$ may not be equal to $(g \circ f)$.

Example 1.4.8 Given $f(x) = 2x - 1$, $g(x) = \cos x$, find each of the following:

(a) $f \circ g$

(b) $g \circ f$

(c) $(f \circ g)\left(\frac{\pi}{3}\right)$

Sol

① $f \circ g = f[g(x)] = 2(\cos x) - 1 = \underline{\underline{2\cos x - 1}}$

② $g \circ f = g[f(x)] = \underline{\underline{\cos(2x-1)}}$

③ $(f \circ g)\left(\frac{\pi}{3}\right) = f\left[g\left(\frac{\pi}{3}\right)\right] = f\left[\frac{1}{2}\right] = 2\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) - 1 = 1 - 1 = \underline{\underline{0}}$

1.5 Even and Odd function

1. **Even Function:** If $f(x)$ satisfied the condition $f(-x) = f(x)$ we called it "even function".
For example $y = f(x) = x^2$

$$f(-x) = (-x)^2 = (-1)^2 x^2 = x^2 = f(x) \Rightarrow f(-x) = f(x)$$

Note: the functions $f(x) = \cos x$ and $f(x) = \sec x$ are even.

2. **Odd Functions:** If $f(x)$ satisfied the condition $f(-x) = -f(x)$ we called it "odd function".
For example $y = f(x) = x^3$

$$f(-x) = (-x)^3 = (-1)^3 x^3 = -x^3 = -f(x) \Rightarrow f(-x) = -f(x)$$

Note: the functions $y = \sin x$, $y = \tan x$, $y = \cot x$, $y = \csc x$ are odd.

Example 1.5.9 Determine whether each function is even, or odd or neither.

(i) $f(x) = x^3 - x$

(ii) $g(x) = 1 + \cos x$

(iii) $h(x) = \frac{\tan x}{1 + \tan x}$

(i) $f(x) = x^3 - x$

$$\begin{aligned} \Rightarrow f(-x) &= (-x)^3 - (-x) \\ &= -x^3 + x = -(x^3 - x) = -f(x) \\ \therefore f(-x) &= -f(x) \Rightarrow \text{odd} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{(ii)} \quad g(-x) &= 1 + \cos(-x) \\ &= 1 + \cos x = g(x) \\ \Rightarrow g(-x) &= g(x) \quad (\text{even}) \end{aligned}$$

Sol (iii) $h(-x) = \frac{\tan(-x)}{1 + \tan(-x)}$

$$\begin{aligned} &= \frac{-\tan x}{1 - \tan x} \neq -\left(\frac{\tan x}{1 + \tan x}\right) \\ &\neq \left(\frac{\tan x}{1 + \tan x}\right) \end{aligned}$$

neither odd nor even

Example 1.5.10 Determine the domain and range of the function:

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 1 - x & , x < 1 \\ \sqrt{x - 1} & , x \geq 1 \end{cases}$$

Sol

Exercise 1.5.1 1. Evaluate (if possible) the function at the given values of the independent variable. Simplify the result

(a) $f(x) = 5 - x^2$

(i) $f(0)$

(ii) $f(-3)$

(iii) $f(b)$

(iv) $f(x - 1)$

(b) $f(x) = \cos 2x$

(i) $f(0)$

(ii) $f\left(-\frac{\pi}{4}\right)$

(iii) $f\left(\frac{\pi}{3}\right)$

2. Find the domain and range of the functions:

$$(i) \ g(x) = x^2 - 5$$

$$(ii) \ f(x) = 4x^2$$

$$(iii) \ h(x) = \frac{3}{x}$$

$$(iv) \ g(x) = \frac{2}{x-1}$$

3. Find the domain of definition of the following functions:

$$(i) \ f(x) = \sqrt{x} + \sqrt{1-x}$$

$$(ii) \ g(x) = \frac{1}{\sin x - \frac{1}{2}}$$

$$(iii) \ f(x) = \frac{1}{|x^2 - 4|}$$

$$(iv) \ f(x) = 2x^3 + \frac{4}{x} + 5$$

$$(v) \ g(x) = x^7 + \frac{3}{\sqrt{x}} - x^2$$

$$(vi) \ h(x) = \frac{2+x}{\sqrt{x}-3}$$

$$(vii) \ f(x) = \left(\frac{x-3}{x-8} \right)^{\frac{1}{2}}$$

$$(viii) \ f(x) = x^2 + 1 + \sqrt{x-2}$$

$$(ix) \ f(x) = x^2 + x + \frac{2}{x^1}$$

$$(x) \ g(x) = x^2 + x^{-3} + 3$$

4. Given $f(x) = \sin x$ and $g(x) = \pi x$, evaluate each expression

$$(i) \ f(g(2))$$

$$(ii) \ f\left(g\left(\frac{1}{2}\right)\right)$$

$$(iii) \ g(f(0))$$

$$(iv) \ g\left(f\left(\frac{\pi}{4}\right)\right)$$

$$(v) \ f(g(x))$$

$$(vi) \ g(f(x))$$